MOUNTAIN REVIEW

OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Volume VII Issue II Spring 2017



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Spring 2017 Event & Membership Meeting

Japanese in Mountain View



Japanese American students belonging to the Young Buddhist Association stand in front of Mtn. View High School in 1928.

Please join us at our Spring Event & Membership Meeting where we will focus on the history of Mountain View's Japanese American community. Our event is timed to celebrate May as Asian Pacific American Heritage Month and to reflect on the 75th anniversary of Japanese internment. We have invited members of Mountain View's Japanese American community to share their stories and memories during the event. As of press time, our speakers include father-daughter duo Ellen Kamei and Ken Kamei. Ellen is a third-generation resident of Mountain View and currently serves on the city's Environmental Planning Commission. Ken was born in a Japanese internment camp during World War II and was part of the first graduating class of Graham Middle School. Together they will share stories about their family's history and their flower nursery business in Mountain View.

We encourage any other members of the community to come to the event and share memories, stories, photos or heirlooms related to local Japanese American history. RSVP not required, but please feel free to contact us at: info@mountainviewhistorical.org or via phone at (650) 903-6890.

Sunday, May 7, 2017 1:00 p.m. to 2:30 p.m.
Historic Adobe Building, 157 Moffett Blvd., Mtn. View

See Page 5 for more historic photos from our archives related to Mountain View's Japanese American community history

MOUNTAIN REVIEW

This newsletter is published four times a year by the
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

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News & Notes

President's Message

By Candace Bowers
MVHA President



Members chat as they take a closer look at a historic map of Mountain View that was brought for show-and-tell at our "I Love Mountain View" Winter Event.

Happy spring!

Thank you to everyone who joined us for our winter event in February, with the Valentine theme of "I Love Mountain View." We shared our favorite memories of our city and, as usual, we learned a lot from our long-time residents. Those of you who are on Facebook will know that our (very active) page is a great way to share photos and stories. But you also won't want to miss our events, where you can meet in person and hear those stories straight from those who've lived them—and who might not be on Facebook. Some of you have commented that it's nice to have a lower-key, less "action-packed" event once in a while so that we can really get to talk.

We took time to reflect on the life of someone who was such a big part of our community, our beloved friend, neighbor, and local historian, Barbara Kinchen. I am constantly amazed by her decades of work to preserve our local history because I see first-hand how her efforts have kept it alive.

I also want to let you know about a proposed project in downtown Mountain View that involves two historic buildings. A developer has submitted an application to build a four-story office building at the site of the Julius Weilheimer house at 938 Villa Street and its neighbor at 954 Villa. (The properties are currently Chez TJ restaurant and the Tied House brew pub.) The Weilheimer house was built in 1894 for Julius Weilheimer, a local merchant, bank officer, and member of the town's first Board of Trustees, and his wife, Fannie. As we understand it, both the Weilheimer house and the Tied House building would be demolished. Representatives of our Association have asked to meet with the developer to learn more about this proposed project, and we will share this information with you as soon as we know. Meanwhile, if you are concerned about this project and the potential loss of this historic site, the time to contact the City Council is now.

See you at our spring event on Sunday, May 7 !

—Candace

History Center Update

By Candace Bowers
MVHA President

We've received some great donations to our archives in the last few months. From Marie Lee are three of her photos taken around town in 1986. Danielle (Scheibli) Petrovic donated a wall calendar given out by the First National Bank in the 1920s, which belonged to her great-grandfather, Harry Scheibli. And David Salinero gave us a set of beautiful photos of the downtown Harvest Parade, taken by Vincent H. Salinero in the 1950s. If you had a chance to see them at our February meeting, you know how exceptionally clear and detailed they are—a remarkable snapshot of old Castro Street businesses such as Lane's Creamery and Wagner's Drug Store, as well as some pretty elaborate parade floats.

Immigrant House Update

By Marina Marinovich
MVHA Publicity Chair

The MVHA continues to work with the Friends of the Immigrant House to find era-appropriate furnishings for the interior of the house. On the master list of items needed are:

Front Parlor/Bedroom
Trunk, Bed, Window Curtains

Kitchen & Pantry
Ice Box, Mason Jars, Typical Pantry Items, Table, Chairs, Flour Bin, Washboard, Sink, Kitchen Stove, Window Curtains

To maintain the authenticity of the exhibit, a threefold process for scouting and donations has been put into place:

1. Items must be from the 1920s era or before.
2. Photos and a description of said items need to be approved by the City for possible inclusion.
3. Items must be approved as historically and aesthetically accurate by the City before they are actually acquired or purchased.

If you have a lead on obtaining any of the furnishing items listed above, please contact the Friends of Immigrant House at (650) 961-8209.

Financial Report

By Emily Ramos
MVHA Treasurer

Checking Account Balance as of 12/14/2016: $21,405.36
Income: $93.67
Expenses: $626.86
Checking Account Balance as of 4/10/2017: $20,872.17

Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 12/14/2016: $59,870.54
Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 4/10/2017: $59,958.66

Board Meeting Recap

By Nick Perry
MVHA Vice President

Your Board of Directors had an especially productive quarterly board meeting on March 23! Here are a few key updates we want to share with our members:

New Board Members. We are excited to announce the appointment of two new members to our Board of Directors! At our meeting we officially elected John Cortez and Anne Marie Montavon. John and Anne Marie will fill our Board's two vacant "Member-at-Large" positions. Thank you John and Anne Marie! We are still looking for a few people to complete our Board. Please contact us if you're interested. The Board meets only four times a year, and we have only four events per year so the time commitment is minimal but your impact on helping our organization fulfil our mission and goals is huge.

Barbara Kinchen Commemoration. During the meeting the Board discussed various ways to commemorate the late Barbara Kinchen's outstanding contribution to MVHA and her extraordinary dedication to the library's History Center. We have decided to create a plaque in her honor that will be displayed in the History Center. We'll keep you all posted on this commemoration as we work on developing its content and design.

Mountain View Veterans Memorial. In 2014, the MVHA donated funds for an interpretive sign at the new Mountain View Veterans Memorial in Eagle Park. The sign will provide information on the memorial and the site's history as the former location of Mountain View Union High School. We continue to coordinate with the organizers of the Mountain View Veterans Memorial to finalize the design of the sign and have it installed at the site. The MVHA has also been invited to participate at the memorial's Memorial Day ceremony on Monday, May 29, 2017, between 11:15 a.m. and 12:00 p.m.

Interpretive Signage Program. Due to limited time/bandwidth, we unfortunately have not made much progress on installing a sign commemorating the site of Arrow Development's original location on Moffett Boulevard. Installing this sign remains a priority for the Board. If anyone would like to help implement this project, please contact us. We're very interested in expanding our interpretive signage program to key historic sites throughout Mountain View.

The date of our next board meeting, tentatively scheduled for mid-June, is still to be determined. But keep an eye out for updates on our Facebook page (www.facebook.com/MVHistory). You can also email us or call the History Center for more information.

The Rengstorff House turns 150

Saturday, May 6, 2017

On Saturday, May 6, 2017, from 11:00 a.m. to 4:00 p.m. the City of Mountain View and the Friends of the R' House will host a community celebration in honor of the Rengstorff House's 150th anniversary.

The free event will take place on the grounds of the historic Rengstorff House at 3070 North Shoreline Boulevard and will include an antique car show, demonstrations, lectures, crafts for kids, live music, food trucks, and more.

The MVHA plans on hosting an information table at the celebration. If any members would like to help staff our table, send an email to info@mountainviewhistorical.org.

For more information on the celebration, visit www.r-house.org.



Become a Rengstorff House Docent!

The MVHA has been asked to help spread the word that the Rengstorff House is currently accepting applications for additional volunteer docents! If you have an interest in early Mountain View history, as well as an appreciation for interacting with people of all ages and backgrounds, contact Kristina.Perino@mountainview.gov or call (650) 903-6073. Training and flexible scheduling opportunities are available!

Japanese in Mountain View

Selected Photos from the History Center Archives



The photo above shows the 1934 class of Mtn. View's Japanese Language School, the Nihongo Gakuen, located at 260 View Street. The school was founded in 1915 to serve the city's growing population of Japanese American children. It was located near a concentration of businesses near Villa and View Street known-then as "Chinatown" but which actually included many businesses owned by members of the Japanese community. After being disbanded during Japanese Internment, it was reformed in 1959. The View Street school building, however, was demolished in 1962.



2017 marks the 75th anniversary of the signing of Executive Order 9066, the proclamation ordering the evacuation of all West Coast residents of Japanese ancestry to internment camps for the duration of World War II. The photo above was taken on May 26, 1942 and shows Mtn. View's Japanese community assembled at the city's train depot to begin their long journey to the camps. At the time, over 100 students at Mtn. View High School were of Japanese descent. One-third of the students in Mountain View Grammar School's class of 1941 were sent to the camps. The city's Japanese language school was disbanded. Japanese family homes, farms, and businesses were abandoned or put in the hands of trusted neighbors. Some families lost everything in the process. Others were able to return to Mountain View and resume their pre-war livelihoods.



This c. 1981 publicity photo for the Mtn. View Buddhist Temple's Obon festival shows Reverend L. Sasaki and a group of girls wearing traditional kimonos in front of the temple. Since it was constructed in 1957, the temple located at 575 N. Shoreline Blvd. has been the center of Japanese American culture in Mountain View. The two-day Obon Festival is an annual midsummer celebration featuring traditional Obon dancing, Japanese and American foods, carnival games, cultural exhibits, a flower market, children's crafts and taiko performances.





The Castro City Grocery and Gas Station was located on Rengstorff Avenue near the railroad tracks. From 1947 to 1992 the store was owned and operated by the Nakamura family and it became a fixture of the Castro City neighborhood. Located at the corner of Rengstorff Avenue and Leland Avenue, the site is now the home of La Plaza Market, formerly Mi Pueblo Market.

Street Talk



By Nick Perry
MVHA Vice President



View of the Satake Nursery from the end of Marilyn Drive c. 2000

If you turn off of Miramonte Avenue on to Marilyn Drive and make your way to the end of the street, you'll find yourself on Satake Court. But not too long ago, this same route would have taken you straight into a hidden remnant of Mountain View's agricultural past.

Satake Court is named after the Satake Family, a Japanese American family with deep roots in Mountain View. The land now occupied by Satake Court was purchased by the family in 1941, when it was part of a 40-acre orchard. Family plans to pull out the orchard and plant row crops were shelved after the bombing of Pearl Harbor and the onset of war between the United States and Japan. The family decided to relocate to Utah before they were placed in an internment camp. A neighbor in Mountain View maintained their orchard during the war years.

After the war, the Satake family returned to Mountain View and resumed their agricultural business. The post-World War II growth boom prompted the family to sell most of their 40-acres for residential development, but they held on to 6.5-acres to operate their family nursery. As residential development quickly replaced the surrounding agricultural land the Satake Nursery quickly became an isolated agricultural island. Marilyn Drive was constructed right to the edge of the nursery's eastern and western borders, but the nursery served as a flower-filled barrier for anyone expecting to use Marilyn Drive to travel between Springer Road and Miramonte Avenue.

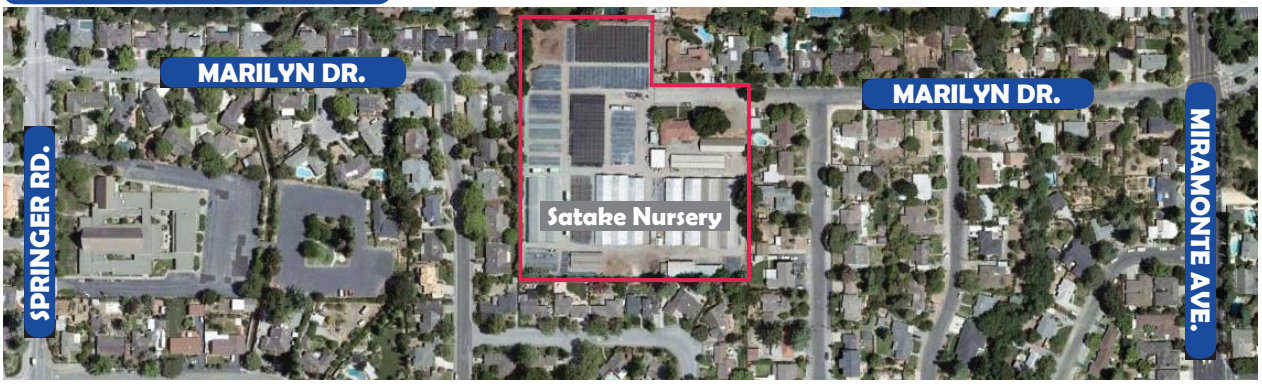
In 2006, the Satake family decided to close the nursery and sell their land. By then, it was one of the last productive agricultural properties in the area. The property was purchased by Summerhill Homes and developed as a single-family home subdivision named "Satake Estates." Original development plans called for finally connecting the western and eastern ends of Marilyn Drive, but concerns about commuter traffic using the street as a cut-through prompted the developers to take a different approach.

Instead, the eastern half of Marilyn Drive turns into a cul-de-sac named Satake Court. The western half of Marilyn Drive turns into a cul-de-sac named Marigold Court, in honor of one of the popular flowers that the Satakes cultivated on the site for six decades. A pathway allows pedestrians and bikes to travel between the two disconnected segments of Marilyn. Both the street names and the conspicuous gap in Marilyn Drive will serve as a reminder of the Satake Nursery's longtime presence.

Aerial View Today



Aerial View c. 2006



Membership

Membership Report

By Lisa Garcia
MVHA Membership Chair

Greetings, members and friends!

I've recently completed the process of converting our membership records from paper card files to a digital spreadsheet and have adjusted our membership counts in the process. The counts reflect the number of members in each category who have paid their membership dues within the past two years, per our organizations rules and procedures.

If you receive this newsletter via postal mail, please check your mailing label. If your name is highlighted on the mailing label our records indicate your membership has expired. Members who receive the newsletter digitally will be notified via email if your membership has expired. If your membership has expired, we hope you'll join us again! You can renew using the form on this page, or online at our website.

If you have any questions on the status of your membership, please e-mail mvha.membership@gmail.com or write us at the mailing address listed below on the membership form.



Save a Stamp:
RENEW OR JOIN ONLINE:
www.mountainviewhistorical.org/membership

Membership as of April 18, 2017

Honored Members	1
Life Members	110
Family Members	60
Single Members	56
TOTAL MEMBERSHIP	**227**

New Member: Molly Kirkley



MVHA MEMBERSHIP FORM

The MVHA welcomes new members! By becoming a member, you are making a special investment in our mission to preserve and share Mtn. View history with the community, conserve priceless archival materials at the History Center, and hold memorable public events throughout the year. Dues are tax deductible to the extent allowed by law. Please support the MVHA, and join or renew today!

- ☐ New Membership
- ☐ Membership Renewal
- ☐ Single Membership: *$15/year*
- ☐ Family Membership: *$25/year*
- ☐ Life Membership *$200*
- ☐ *I'm interested in volunteer opportunities*

Name: _____

Street Address: _____

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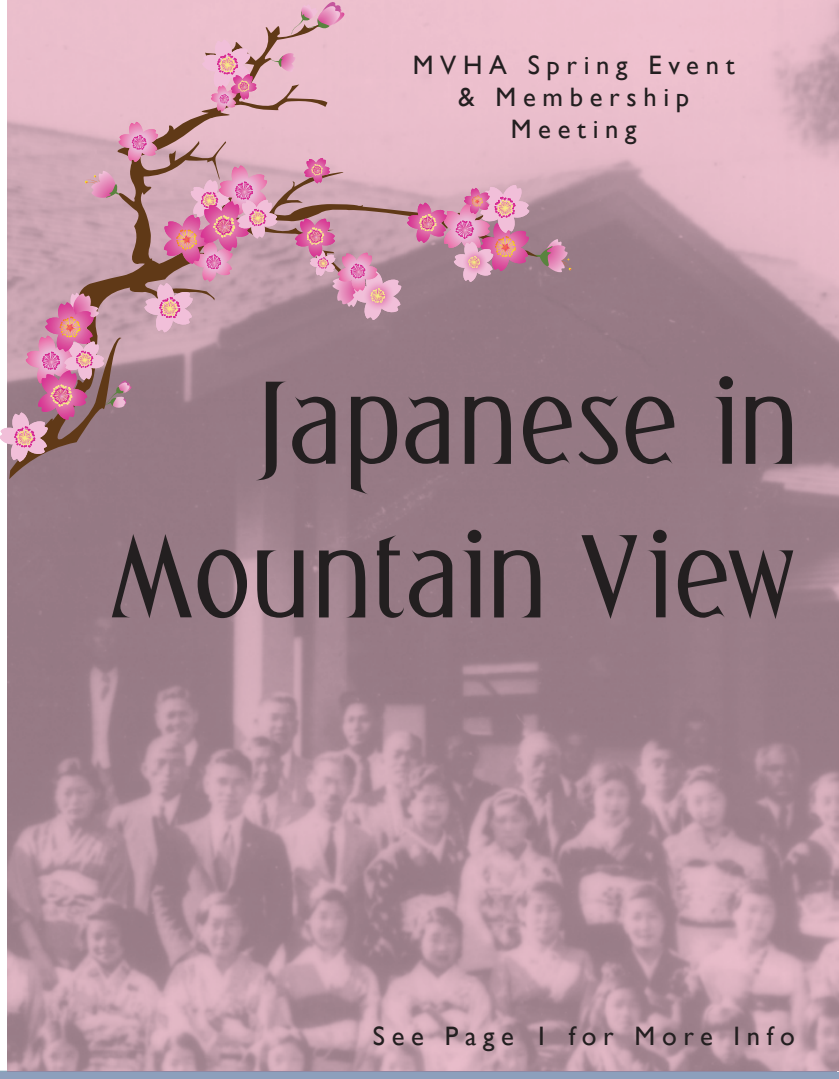
SPRING/SUMMER

May 6
Saturday 11:00 a.m. to 4:00 p.m.
Rengstorff House 150th
Rengstorff House - 2070 N. Shoreline Blvd.
Details on page 4

May 7
Sunday, 1:00 to 2:30 p.m.
MVHA Spring Event/Meeting
Adobe Building - 157 Moffett Blvd.
"Japanese in Mountain View" - Details on page 1

Spring Board Meeting
Date & Time TBA
M.V. Library History Center, 585 Franklin St.
Email info@mountainviewhistorical.org

August 6
Sunday, 1:00 to 2:30 p.m.
MVHA Summer BBQ
Adobe Building - 157 Moffett Blvd.
More info in our Summer newsletter!



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MOUNTAIN REVIEW
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